

MIKOMI

—— 日本語学院 ——

WHERE YOUR JAPANESE JOURNEY BEGINS

MIKOMI JAPANESE LANGUAGE INSTITUTE

4-Month JLPT N5 Study Planner

がくしゅう プランナー

AUGUST → DECEMBER 2026 · ROAD TO N5

Prepared by **Mikomi Japanese Language Institute**

Founder — Astha Pokhriyal | JLPT N2 Certified | 6+ Years Teaching

Learn Japanese. Unlock Global Opportunities.

How This Planner Works はじめに

A calm, steady 4-month path from absolute beginner to JLPT N5 ready — timed perfectly for the December 2026 exam. Four months of consistent, gentle study beats months of cramming. You can do this!

⚠ Register early — seats fill fast!

The JLPT N5 exam is on **Sunday, 6 December 2026**. In India, registration usually opens in **mid-to-late August** and is **first-come, first-served** — portals often close early once seats fill. **Do not wait**. Register as soon as your local test centre's portal opens. Dates and centres vary by city, so always confirm with your own centre (e.g. MOSAI Delhi, or the Japan Foundation).

◆ The 4-month plan at a glance

August

はちがつ・Month 1

FOUNDATIONS

- ◆ Master Hiragana & Katakana
- ◆ First 150 vocabulary words
- ◆ Register for the exam!

September

くがつ・Month 2

BUILDING BLOCKS

- ◆ Core N5 grammar (part 1)
- ◆ Vocabulary to 350 words
- ◆ First 40 kanji

October

じゅうがつ・Month 3

PUTTING IT TOGETHER

- ◆ Remaining N5 grammar
- ◆ All 500 vocabulary words
- ◆ Kanji to 80+

November

じゅういちがつ・Month 4

REVIEW & MOCK TESTS

- ◆ Full review of everything
- ◆ Weekly mock tests
- ◆ Listening practice & exam skills



The golden rule: 30–45 minutes a day, every day, beats 5 hours once a week. Little and often is how languages stick. This planner is built around gentle daily habits — never overwhelming, always moving forward.

TIMELINE

Key Dates & Milestones 大切な日

Your countdown to exam day. Print this page and keep it where you'll see it every day.

Mid-Aug

Registration opens (India, most centres). Watch your local centre's portal daily and apply immediately.

End Aug

Milestone 1: You can read and write all Hiragana and Katakana confidently.

Late Aug-Sep

Registration closes — varies by centre, often early once seats fill. Confirm you're registered!

End Sep

Milestone 2: Core grammar started, ~350 words, first 40 kanji known.

End Oct

Milestone 3: All N5 grammar covered, 500 words, 80+ kanji. Start mock tests.

Nov

Mock test month: One full mock test each weekend. Review mistakes carefully.

Early Dec

Final review & rest. Light revision only. Sleep well before exam day.

Dec 6

🌸 **JLPT N5 Exam Day!** You're ready. Stay calm, trust your preparation. Ganbatte!



Please note: Exam registration dates and procedures differ by test city and can change year to year. The exam date (6 Dec 2026) is fixed worldwide, but always verify registration details with your own local JLPT test centre. This planner is a study guide, not an official registration source.

YOUR WEEK

A Balanced Weekly Rhythm 一週間

Every week follows the same gentle rhythm so studying becomes an easy habit. Here's your template — adapt it to your life.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
New material Learn something new — grammar or vocab	Practice Practise Monday's material with exercises	New material Learn the next point — build steadily	Kanji + vocab Focus on characters and words	Review Revise everything from this week	Listening + reading Fun input: audio, simple texts	Rest / light review Relax! Optional gentle revision

☐ Study day ☐ Input day ☐ Rest day



Why a rest day matters. Your brain consolidates learning while you rest. Taking Sunday lighter isn't lazy — it's smart. You'll come back Monday sharper. Consistency over months is what wins, not burnout.

◆ Daily 40-minute template

Warm-up · 5 min - Review yesterday's words aloud - Read a few hiragana/katakana lines	Core study · 25 min - New grammar or vocabulary - Write example sentences
Practice · 7 min Quiz yourself or do exercises	Cool-down · 3 min Note what to review tomorrow

August — Foundations はちがつ

Your first month is all about the two Japanese alphabets and your first words. Get these solid and everything else becomes easy. And don't forget — register for the exam this month!

◆ Weekly goals

Week 1

Hiragana: vowels through は-row. Write each character daily. Learn 20 vocab words.

Week 2

Finish hiragana (ま-row to ん). Start katakana vowels & か-row. 40 more words.

Week 3

Finish katakana. Learn dakuten & combined sounds. 40 more words. Register for exam!

Week 4

Consolidate both scripts. Reading practice. Reach 150 words total. Self-check.

◆ This month's checklist

- ☐ Learn all 46 hiragana (reading + writing)
- ☐ Learn all 46 katakana (reading + writing)
- ☐ Learn dakuten, handakuten & combined sounds
- ☐ Master the first 150 vocabulary words (Family, Food, Daily Life, Numbers)
- ☐ Learn to greet and introduce yourself
- ☐ ★ REGISTER FOR THE JLPT N5 EXAM as soon as your centre opens
- ☐ Take the Week 4 self-check: write any kana from memory

September — Building Blocks くがつ

Now you can read! This month you meet Japanese grammar and your first kanji. Take it gently — grammar clicks with examples and repetition.

◆ Weekly goals

Week 1

Particles は, を, も. Basic です sentences. 50 words. Kanji 1–10 (numbers).

Week 2

Particles に, へ, で. Verb ます-form. 50 words. Kanji 11–20 (time/days).

Week 3

Negative & past forms. Adjectives (い & な). 50 words. Kanji 21–30.

Week 4

Review all grammar so far. Reach 350 words. Kanji 31–40. Mini self-test.

◆ This month's checklist

- ☐ Learn core N5 grammar part 1 (です／は／を／に／へ particles)
- ☐ Understand basic sentence structure (subject-object-verb)
- ☐ Learn present & past, positive & negative verb forms
- ☐ Grow vocabulary from 150 to 350 words
- ☐ Learn your first 40 kanji (numbers, days, basic nouns)
- ☐ Write 5 simple sentences about yourself
- ☐ Confirm your exam registration is complete

October — Putting It Together じゅうがつ

The pieces come together this month. You'll finish the N5 grammar, complete your vocabulary, and push kanji past 80. By month's end you'll have covered the whole syllabus.

◆ Weekly goals

Week 1

て-form and requests. Counters. 40 words. Kanji 41–55.

Week 2

Question words (なに, どこ, いつ...). Comparisons. 40 words. Kanji 56–70.

Week 3

Remaining grammar (~たい, ~ましょう, から). 40 words. Kanji 71–85.

Week 4

Finish 500 words. Review all grammar & kanji. First practice test.

◆ This month's checklist

- ☐ Complete all remaining N5 grammar points
- ☐ Learn question words & how to ask questions naturally
- ☐ Learn て-form and its everyday uses
- ☐ Reach the full 500 vocabulary words
- ☐ Grow kanji from 40 to 80+
- ☐ Read short simple passages without help
- ☐ Take your first half-length practice test

November — Review & Mock Tests じゅういちがつ

The home stretch! No new material — this month is pure review, practice tests, and building exam confidence. Focus on listening, which many beginners find hardest.

◆ Weekly goals

Week 1

Mock test 1 (untimed). Review weak areas. Daily listening (10 min).

Week 2

Mock test 2 (timed). Grammar & vocab revision rotation. Listening.

Week 3

Mock test 3 (timed). Focus on your weakest section. Reading speed.

Week 4

Mock test 4. Light review only. Prepare documents. Rest before exam!

◆ This month's checklist

- ☐ Complete a full mock test every weekend (4 total)
- ☐ Review every mock test carefully — learn from mistakes
- ☐ Daily listening practice (the N5 has a listening section)
- ☐ Revise all grammar, vocabulary and kanji in rotation
- ☐ Practise reading under time pressure
- ☐ Learn exam-day strategies & timing
- ☐ Rest well in the final days — arrive calm and confident

Mock Test Schedule 模擬試験

Mock tests are the single best predictor of exam success. They build stamina, timing, and confidence. Here's your schedule — treat each one seriously.

Test 1 • Early Nov

Diagnostic — untimed

- ◆ Take it relaxed, no clock
- ◆ See where you stand
- ◆ Note your weak sections

Test 2 • Mid Nov

First timed test

- ◆ Full exam conditions
- ◆ Practise pacing yourself
- ◆ Compare to Test 1

Test 3 • Late Nov

Target weak areas

- ◆ Timed, exam conditions
- ◆ Focus revision on weak spots
- ◆ Build listening stamina

Test 4 • Final week

Confidence builder

- ◆ Should feel comfortable now
- ◆ Confirm your timing works
- ◆ Then rest and trust yourself

◆ The N5 exam structure — know what to expect

- ☐ **Section 1 — Language Knowledge** (Vocabulary): ~20 minutes
- ☐ **Section 2 — Language Knowledge** (Grammar) & Reading: ~40 minutes
- ☐ **Section 3 — Listening:** ~30 minutes



Don't neglect listening! It's a full third of the exam and the part self-taught beginners often underestimate. Listen to simple Japanese every day in November — even 10 minutes helps enormously.



Note: Exact section timings and format can be confirmed on the official JLPT website. Use official sample questions (free on jlpt.jp) for your most realistic mock tests.

ADVICE

Study Tips for Success 勉強のコツ

Six years of teaching distilled into the habits that actually work. Small, consistent actions add up to fluency.

Study a little every day. Consistency beats intensity. 30 minutes daily for four months will take you further than occasional long sessions. Make it a habit, like brushing your teeth.

Say everything out loud. Reading silently isn't enough. Speak words and sentences aloud — it builds pronunciation, memory, and confidence all at once.

Use what you learn. Write your own sentences. Label things in your home in Japanese. Text a study buddy. Active use locks knowledge in far better than re-reading.

Review, review, review. We forget most of what we learn within days unless we revisit it. Build review into every week — old material stays fresh, new material sticks.

Don't fear mistakes. Mistakes are how you learn. Every error you make and correct is progress. Beginners who aren't afraid to be wrong improve the fastest.

Make it enjoyable. Watch anime with subtitles, listen to Japanese music, cook a Japanese recipe. Enjoyment keeps you going when motivation dips.

Track your progress. Tick off this planner's checklists. Seeing how far you've come is powerful motivation on hard days.

Ask for help. Stuck on something? Don't struggle alone. Reach out to Mikomi on WhatsApp — we're here to help you succeed.



頑張って！

Ganbatte — you've got this!

Four months from now, you'll walk into that exam ready. Trust the plan, show up each day, and be kind to yourself along the way. Thousands of beginners have passed the N5 with steady effort — you can too. Whenever you need guidance, Mikomi is only a message away.

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